Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ — ♥ K 8 4 ♦ A K J 7 6 5 2 ♣ A 6 5	
♠ A K 7 5 4 3 ♥ J 9 5 ♦ — ♣ J 10 7 2	N W E S	♠ 10 9 6 ♥ Q 10 7 2 ♦ 9 4 3 ♣ K Q 8
	♠ Q J 8 2 ♥ A 6 3 ♦ Q 10 8 ♣ 9 4 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♠	Dbl	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	5♦		
All Pass			

5♦ by North
Lead: ♠10

3NT would have been a lot easier, but you didn't get there. North is to play 5♦. East leads the ♠10.

West plays the ♠K and you ruff with the ♦2.

East plays low.

West shows out.

West covers with the ♠A.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 3

The good news is that you only have one loser to get rid of. The bad news is that there doesn't seem to be a good place to put it.

Unlikely as it seems, your best candidate for establishment is dummy's ♠8. East is marked with 3 ♠s, and having led the ♠10 there is a good chance that he also has the ♠9. If so you can ruff it out.

Cover the ♠10 with dummy's ♠J, and when West plays one of his honors ruff in your hand. Play a trump to the ♦10, West showing out. Lead the ♠Q. West will be forced to play his other high honor, (if he doesn't you would discard a loser), and you ruff again.

Back to dummy with the ♦Q and ruff the ♠2 with a high trump just to be safe. East drops the ♠9 on this trick.

Pull East's last trump and enter dummy with the ♥A and **FINALLY** discard a loser on the now established ♠8.

When your only hope of making a contract is for the defender's cards to be a certain way, just assume that they lie perfectly for you and barge ahead.

Here you needed ♠ 10 9 x to be with East if you were to make the contract so you played for just that holding.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 8 2 ♥ Q 8 2 ♦ Q 10 9 4 ♣ Q J 7 2	
♠ K 6 4 ♥ A 9 3 ♦ 8 6 ♣ 9 8 6 4 3		♠ A Q J 10 9 7 ♥ K 10 5 ♦ A 5 ♣ A K
	♠ 5 3 ♥ J 7 6 4 ♦ K J 7 3 2 ♣ 10 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	Pass	2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♠ by East
Lead: ♠5

East is to play 6♠. South leads the ♠5.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 2

First pull trumps with the ♠A and ♠Q, both defenders following. Next you must establish dummy's ♣ suit to get rid of one of your losers. If the suit splits 3-3 that will be easy since you have two dummy entries, one to get there to ruff the third ♣ and the other to get there to enjoy playing the winners. But ♣s will probably split 4-2 so the two entries won't be enough. Here's how to make the defenders help you establish the suit.

After pulling trumps, play the ♣ A K, then ♦A.

You exit with a small ♦ and North wins.

The defender who won the ♦ trick has a problem. If he plays another ♦ you will get a ruff-sluff, and if he plays a ♥ you will play for the ♥Q and ♥J to be in different hands. So he will probably play a ♣.

You ruff in your hand, play a trump to dummy's ♠K and ruff the ♣8, establishing the ♣9 while you still have the ♥ entry.

Notice that this Plan would also succeed if the ♣s had split 3-3.

This was a combination of Suit Establishment and End-play. The lesson on Eliminations contains a lot more of this type of hand.